



Roan C.

IAT309W Portfolio

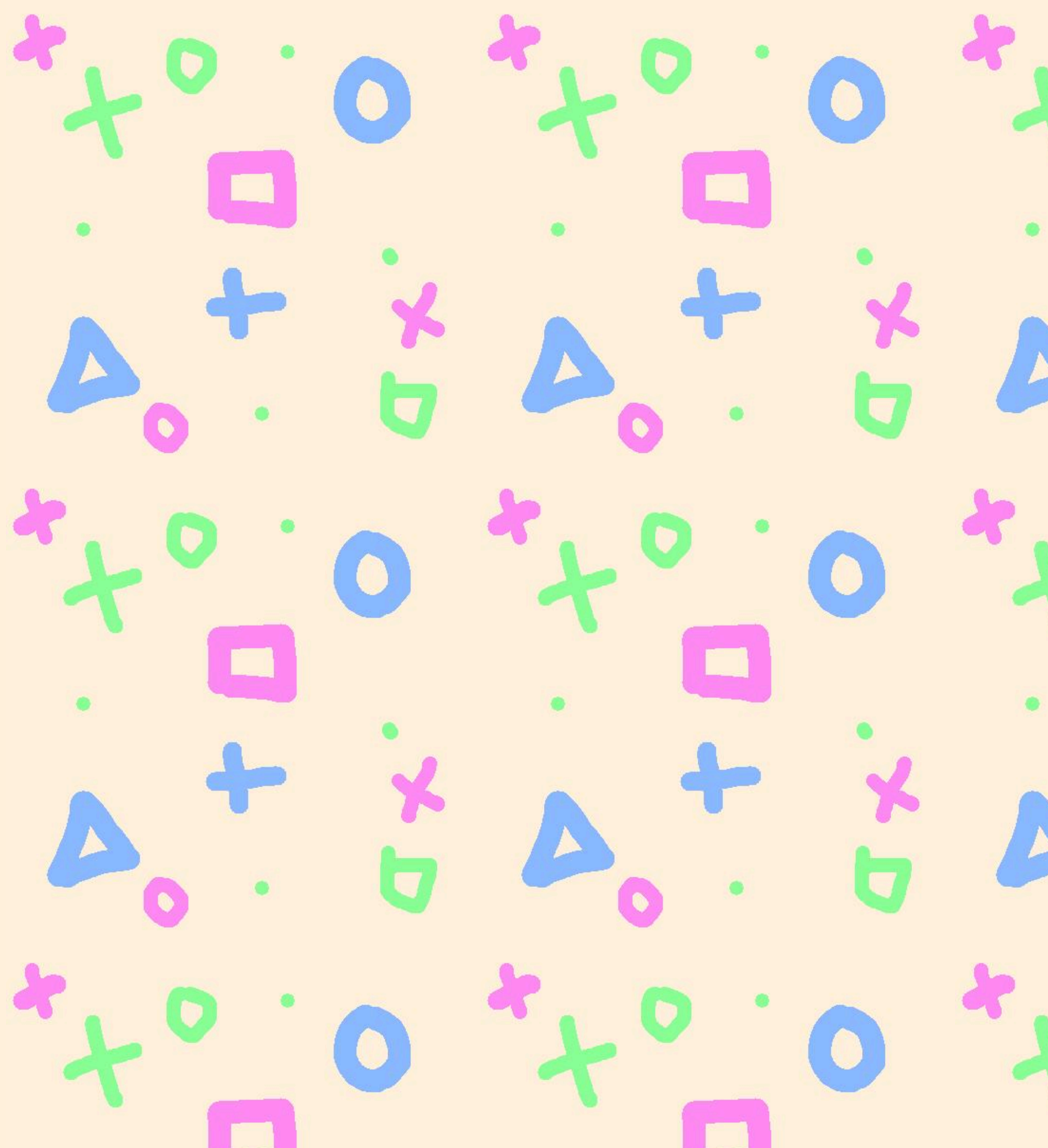


Figure 1.
Dios Coming Through a Mirror



Note: The image depicts Dios, the main character of a game project I have been developing for a few years now. Dios is a very important character to me and represents my growth as a creative. From *Dios Coming Through a Mirror* [Digital Illustration], by Roan Clifford, 2023.

Hey there! I'm Roan,

a game developer and digital artist in my fourth year of a bachelors in Interactive Arts and Technologies.

I am especially interested in designing gameplay and systems, as well as 2d and 3d character art and animation. Overall, I want to create art that is fun and diverse, built by a passion to learn and apply new things. Through educational settings and personal interest, I gained familiarity with game engines including unity, unreal, as well as godot. Additionally, as an IAT student with a computer science minor, I have developed a better understanding of c/c++, python, JavaScript, and c#.

(104 Words)

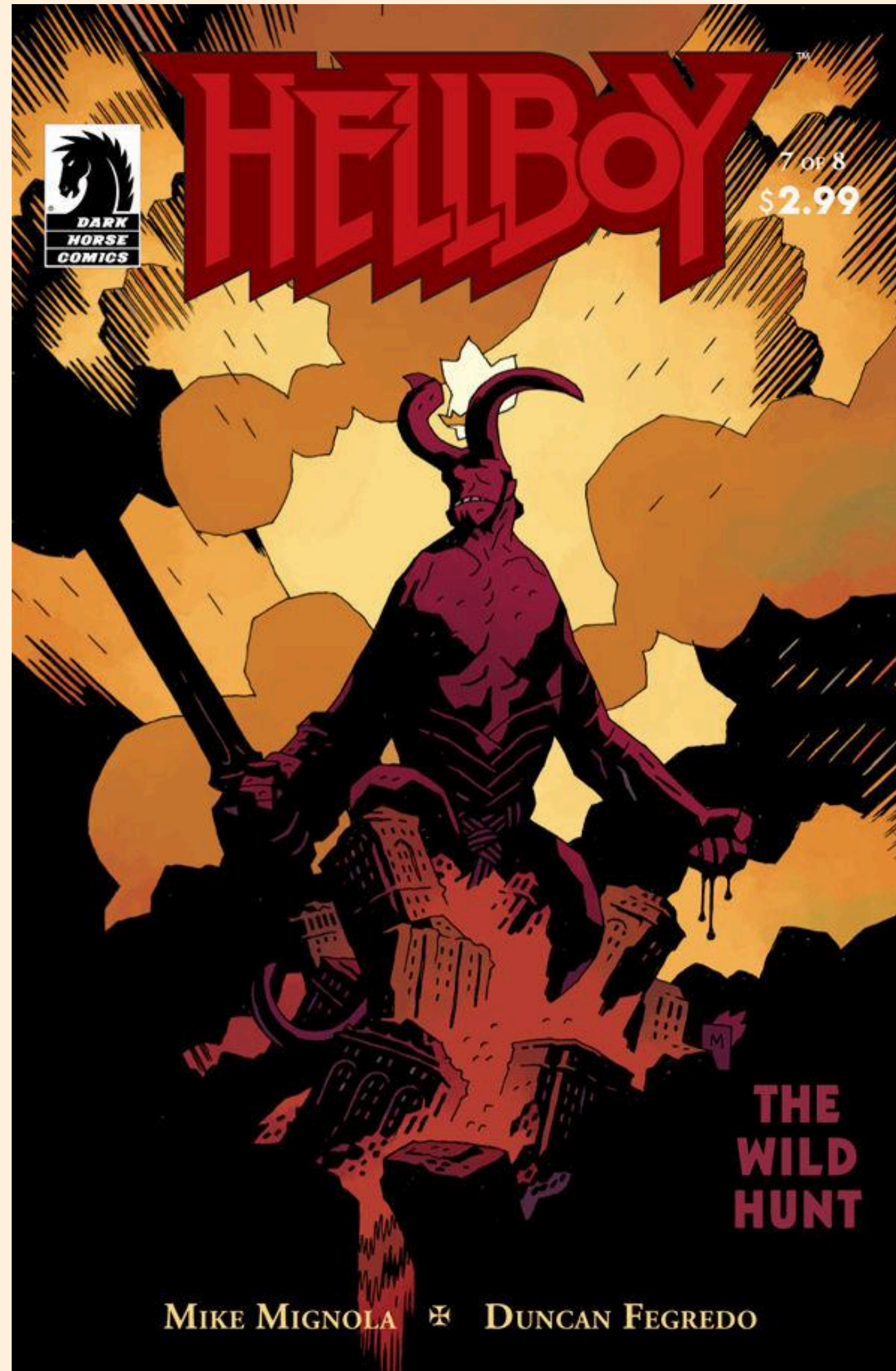
Inspiration

One of my many inspirations as an artist comes from the works of Mike Mignola, especially the series Hellboy. As shown in figure 2, Mignola's art is colourful with style defining black shadows which carve shapes into the world. Mignola also creates visually intriguing creatures with exaggerated proportions that fit perfectly in place within the world he has crafted.

Leon, pictured in figure 3, is a character whose design came about as a result of Mignola's influence as an artist on me. I wanted to create a character with more exaggerated proportions like large hands and fingers. I would say that Leon is certainly more cartoony than Mignola's work and that would be because of my other influences such as western cartoons which fit the tone of the project. Although I still enjoy drawing with more grounded proportions and darker colour palettes, Mignola's work has definitely influenced me to go outside of my comfort zone and experiment a little more, even when creating art that is more serious.

(157 Words)

Figure 2.
The Wild Hunt #7



Note: An illustrated cover depicting a version of the character Hellboy. From *The Wild Hunt* #7 [Illustration], by Mike Mignola, 2009, Dark Horse Comics (<https://www.darkhorse.com/comics/15-374/hellboy-the-wild-hunt-7/>). Copyright 2009 by Dark Horse Comics LLC.

Figure 3.
Leon NMBR1 Concept Art



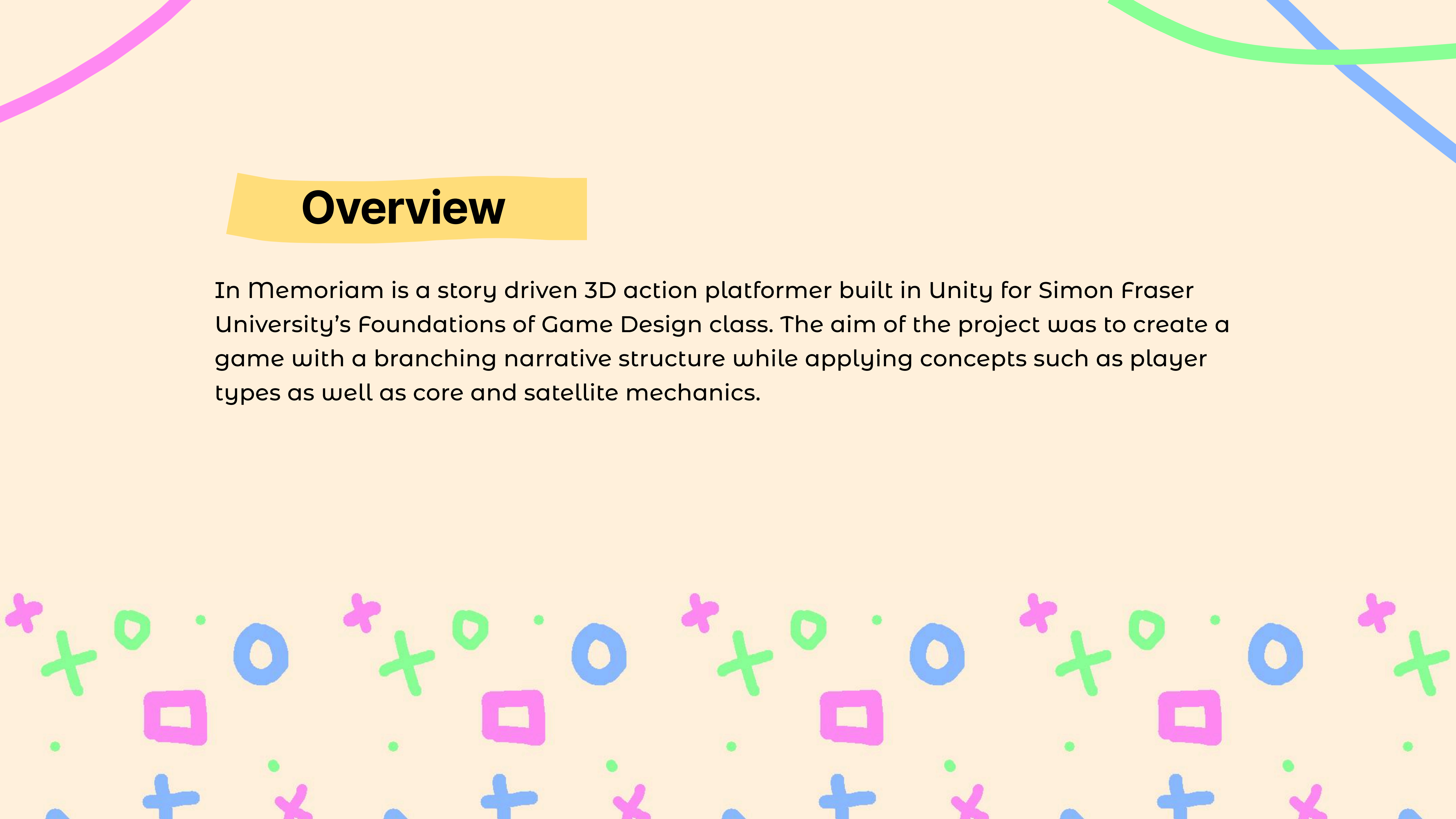
Note: A piece of concept art depicting the street racer Leon, created for a project for the class Animation at Simon Fraser University. From Leon NMBR1 Concept Art [Digital Illustration], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Project Showcase: In Memoriam

Figure 4.
End1



Note: A frame from the ending sequence of In Memoriam wherein the protagonist is judged and allowed to leave purgatory. From End 1 [Digital Illustration], by Lynn Cao, 2025, In Memoriam.



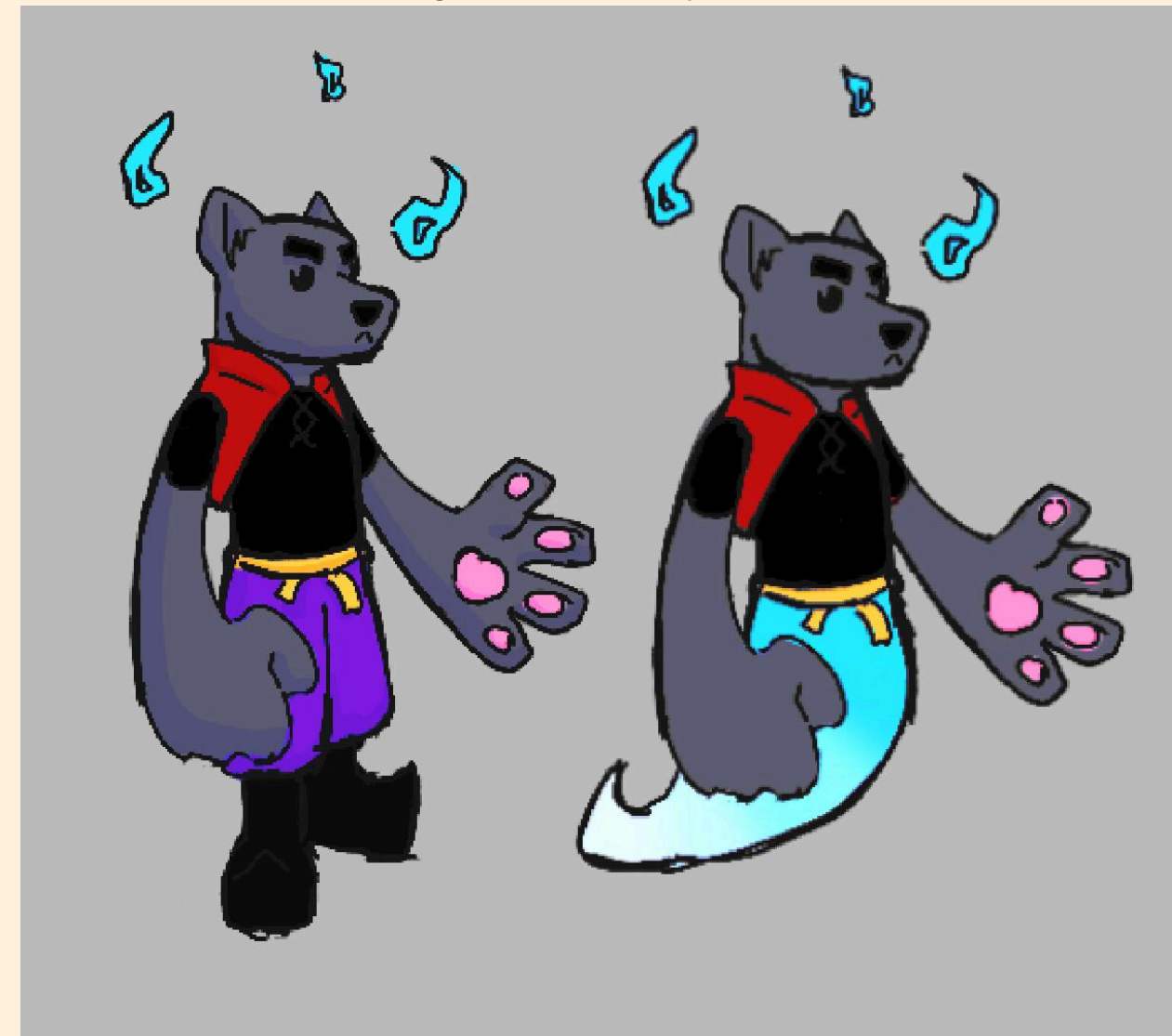
Overview

In Memoriam is a story driven 3D action platformer built in Unity for Simon Fraser University's Foundations of Game Design class. The aim of the project was to create a game with a branching narrative structure while applying concepts such as player types as well as core and satellite mechanics.

Art Dev.

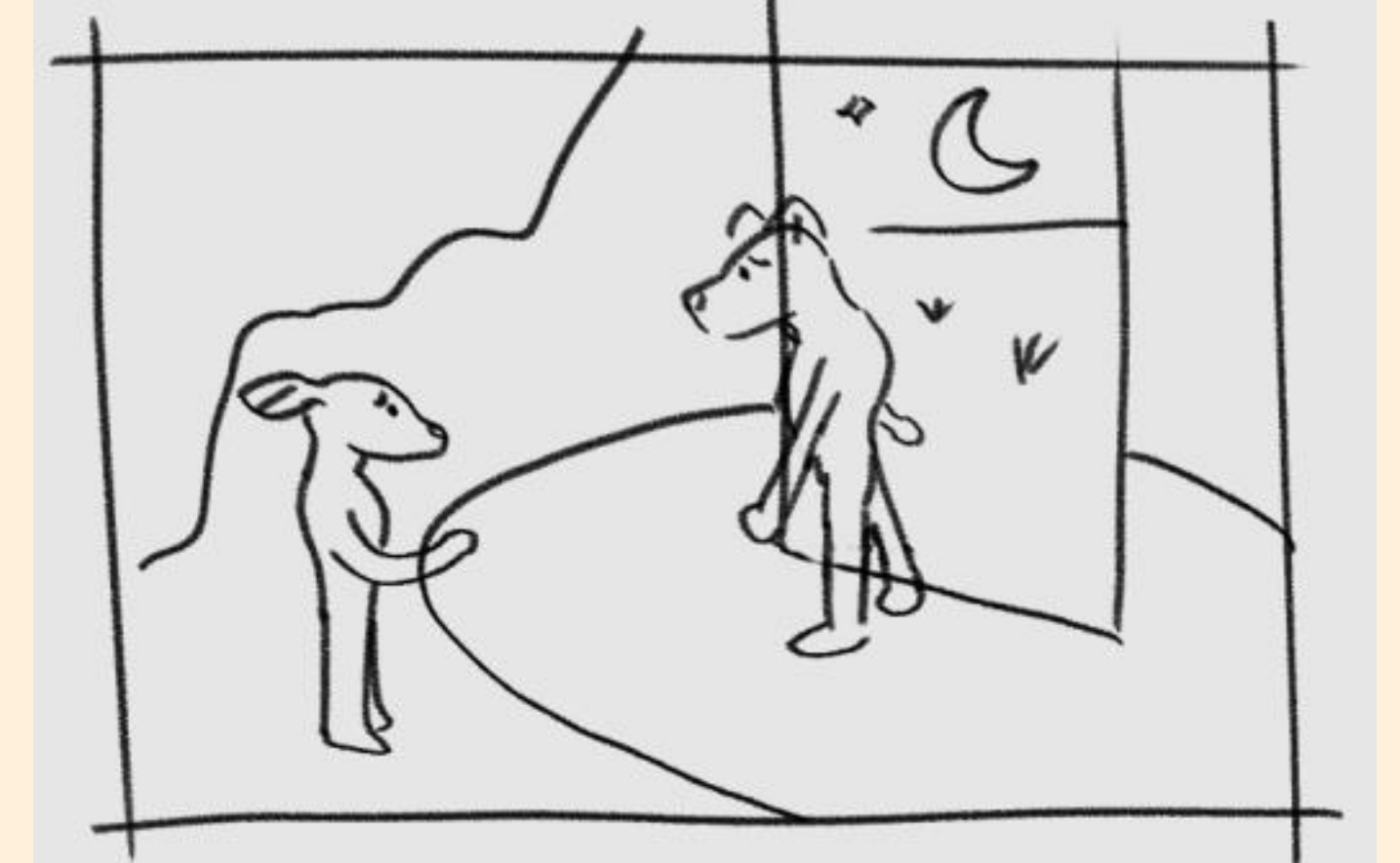
Prior to production, I contributed to the art of In Memoriam with a concept design for the player character (as shown in figure 5), and some rough storyboards for narrative beats (as shown in figures 6 and 7). Although my character design did not make it through to the end, elements of the design such as clothing genre were kept.

Figure 5.
In Memoriam Protagonist Concept Art



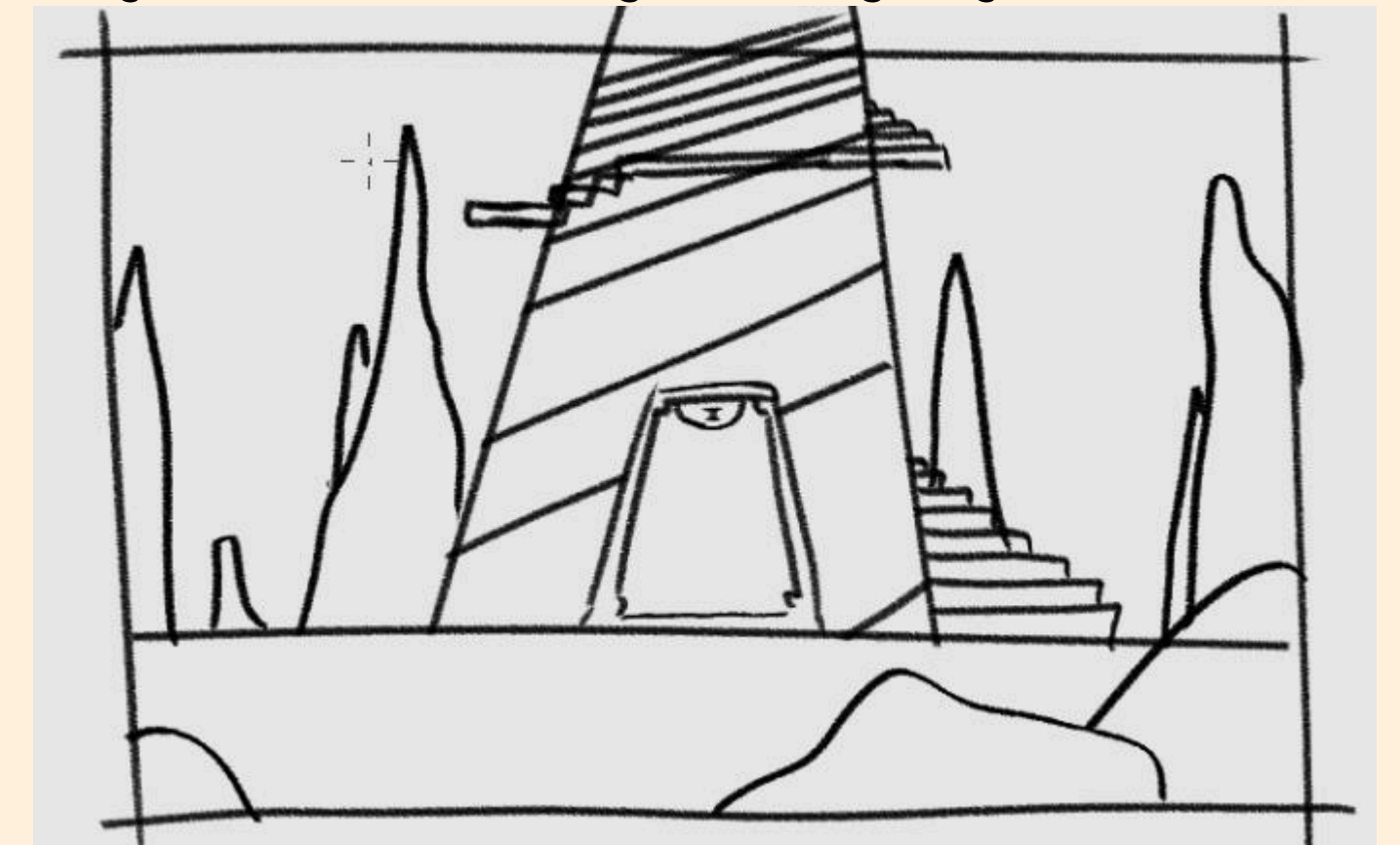
Note: Initial concept for the protagonist of In Memoriam before final design was approved. From In Memoriam Protagonist Concept Art [Digital Illustration], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Figure 6.
Storyboard of Protagonist Leaving their Companion Behind



Note: A storyboard depicting a potential scene where the player leaves their travelling companion behind as they escape from purgatory. From Storyboard of Protagonist Leaving their Companion Behind [Digital sketch], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Figure 7.
Storyboard of Tower Leading out of Purgatory



Note: A storyboard depicting a potential scene where the player gets to see the tower leading out of purgatory. From Storyboard of Tower Leading out of Purgatory [Digital sketch], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Figure 8.
Enemy Class

```
Assets > Enemies > Enemy > Wander
public class enemy : MonoBehaviour, IDamageable
{
    protected virtual void Update()
    {
        switch(state){
            case WANDER:
                Wander();
                break;
            case PURSUE:
                Pursue();
                break;
        }

        animator.SetFloat("Vel x", navAgent.velocity.magnitude);
    }

    1 reference
    protected virtual void Wander(){
        if(idleTimer >= idleTime){
            //if idle for long enough -> pick a new spot to move towards
            targetLocation = new Vector3(startingLocation.x + Random.Range(-maxWanderDistance, maxWanderDistance),
            startingLocation.y, startingLocation.z + Random.Range(-maxWanderDistance, maxWanderDistance));
            navAgent.SetDestination(targetLocation);
            idleTimer = 0;
            idleTime = Random.Range(0, idleTimeMax);
        }
        if(navAgent.pathStatus == NavMeshPathStatus.PathComplete){
            idleTimer += Time.deltaTime;
        }
    }

    1 reference
    protected virtual void Pursue(){
        navAgent.destination = targetLocation;
    }

    2 references
    public void TakeDamage(int damage)
    {
        StartCoroutine(DamageColour());
        if(health > 0){

```

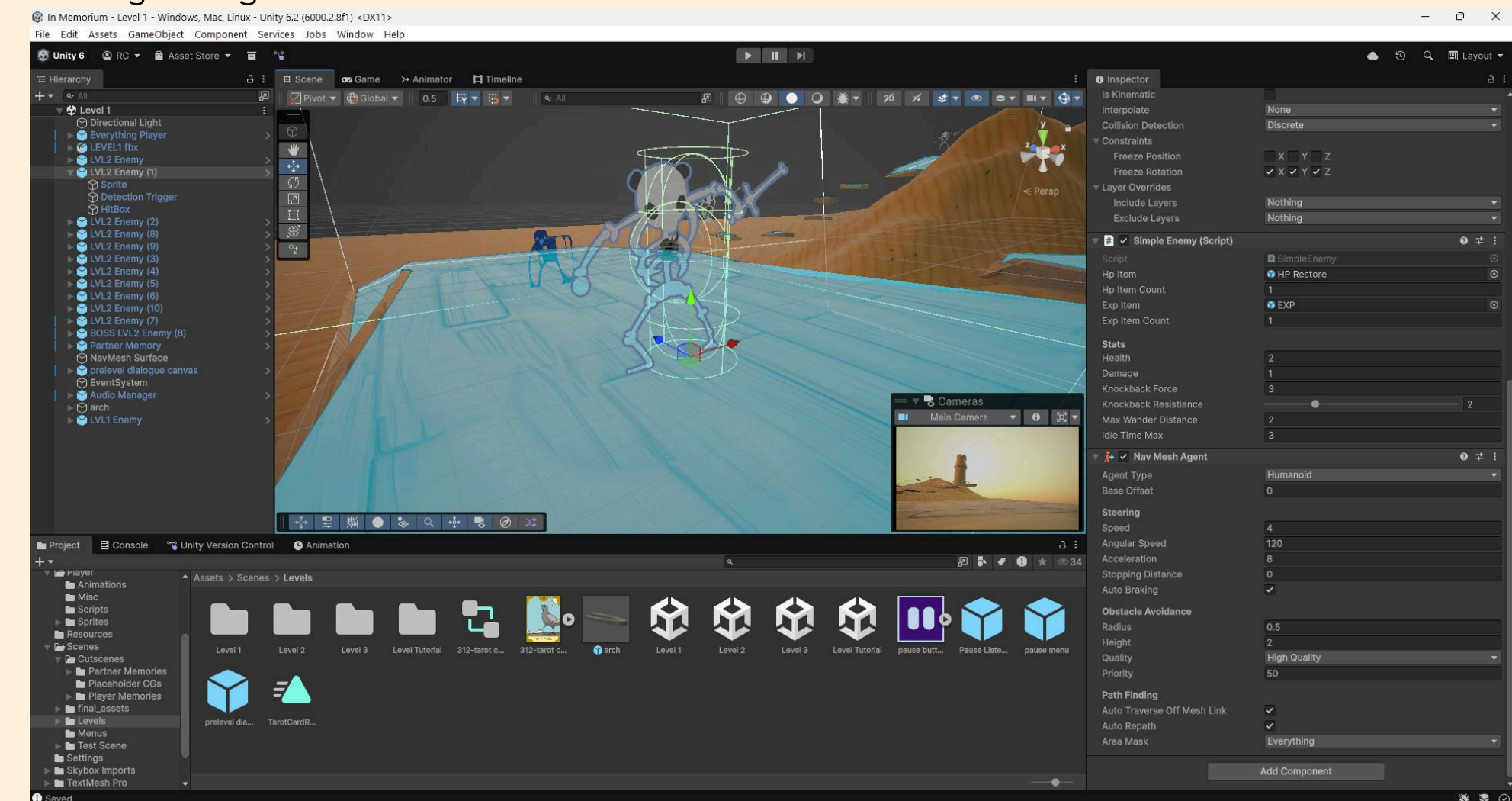
Note: A screenshot of code used in In Memoriam that depicts the base class for enemies in game. From Enemy Class [Screenshot], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Development 1

My focus initially was to implement the foundational mechanics of our game as an action platformer: movement and camera controls. From here, I moved onto combat, health, and enemy behaviours (as shown in figure 8) that could be inherited from to create a variety of enemies.

Although the game's scope was relatively small, I wanted to create an easily expandable system to make every enemy different. Figure 9 shows the result, a completed enemy and its editable properties. Were I to work on this project further, I would easily be able to add more unique behaviours to each enemy such as more complicated or unique attacks.

Figure 9.
Enemy in Engine

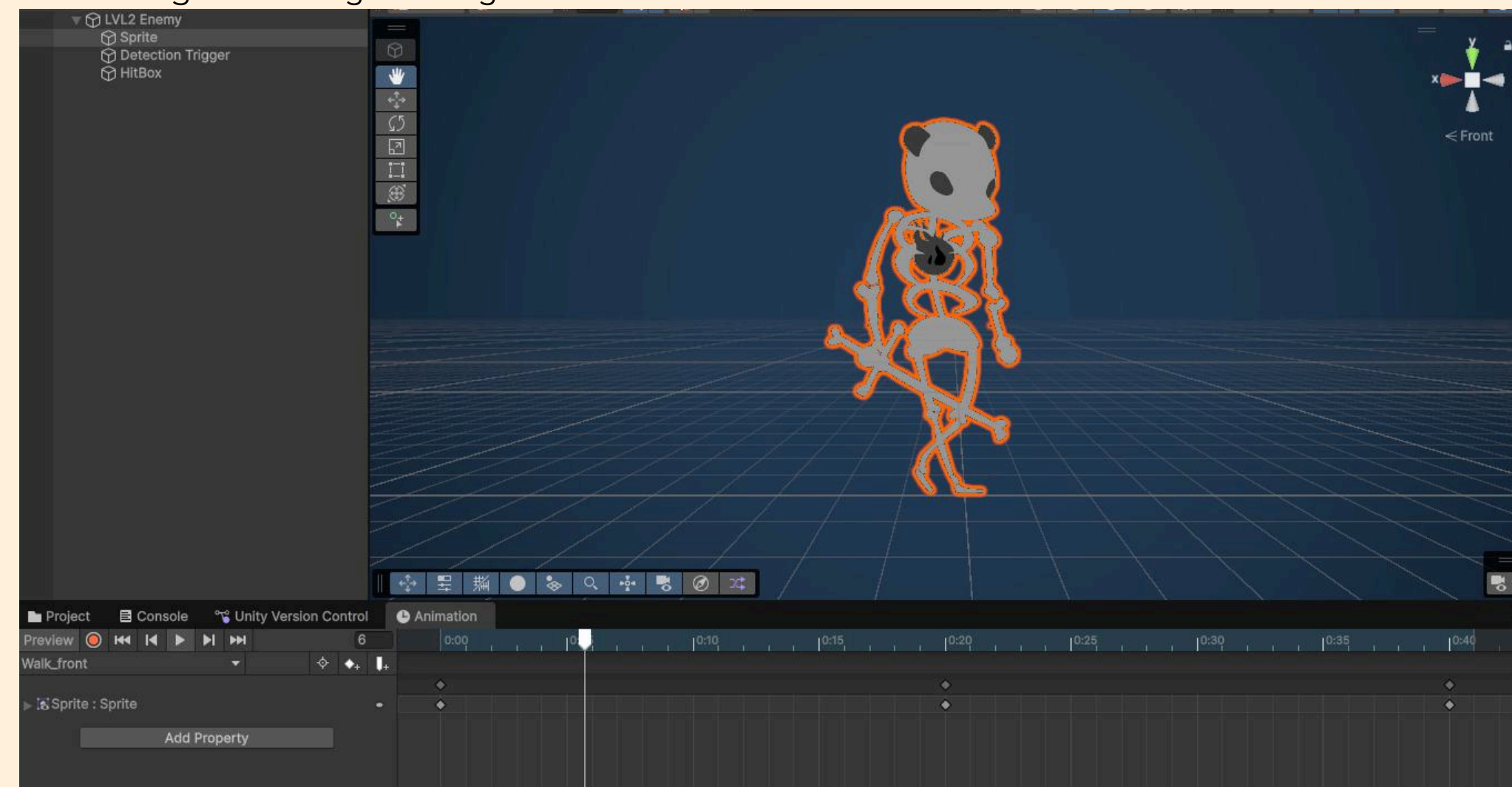


Note: A screenshot of an enemy of In Memoriam as shown in the Unity game engine. From Enemy in Engine [Screenshot], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Development 2

Outside of programming, I was also the most experienced in using Unity and did much of the work bringing over the art and animation created by our group's lead artist. Figure 8 shows some of this process as I use the sprites created by the team's artist.

Figure 10.
Animating an Enemy in Unity

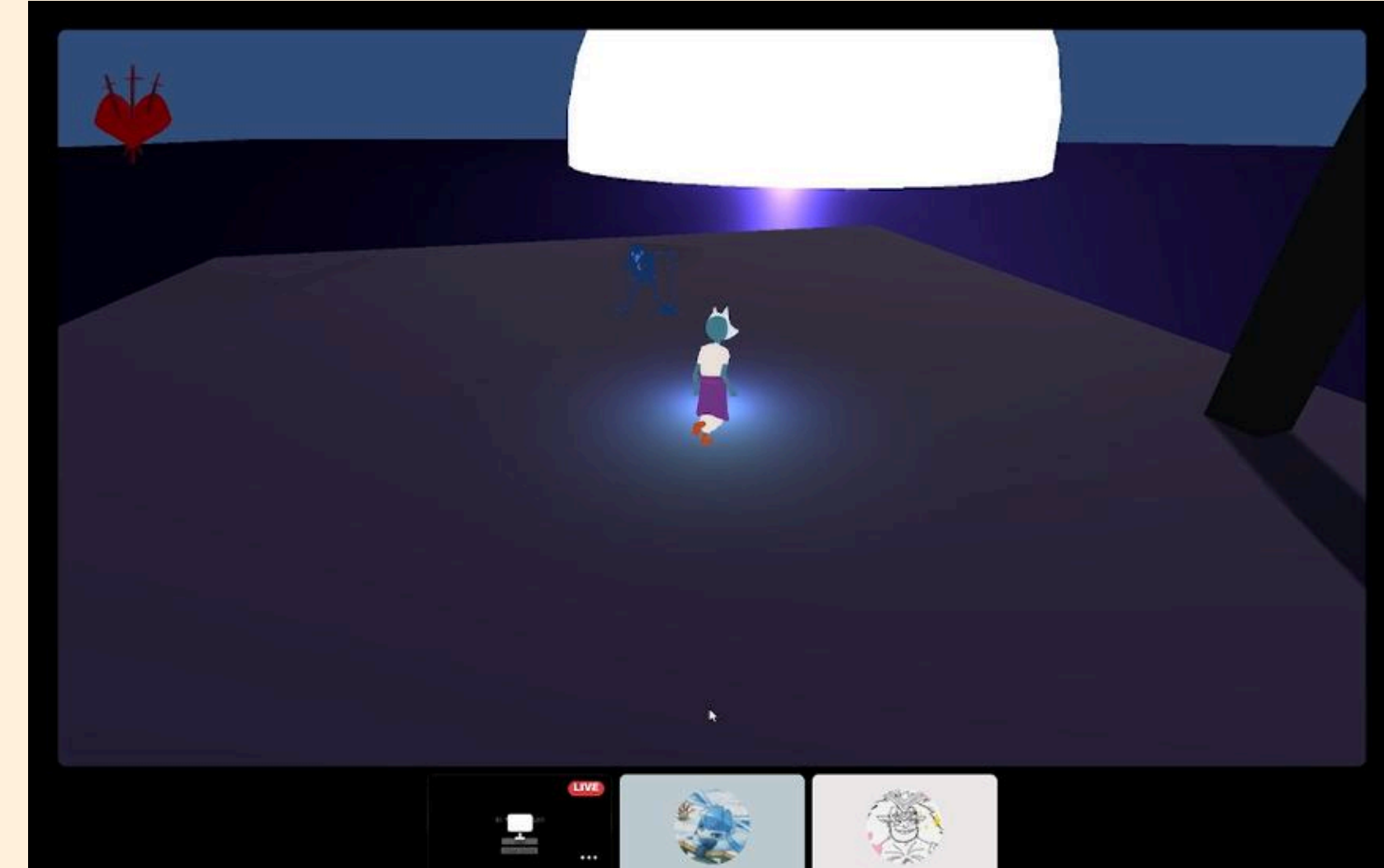


Note: A screenshot showing the process of animating an enemy in the Unity game engine. From Animating an Enemy in Unity [Screenshot], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Challenges

Because the player is 2D in a 3D environment and we only had sprites from one camera perspective, playtesters struggled to gauge where the player was going to land after a jump. To fix this, I moved the player character's light closer to their feet so players could use it as a shadow. This change can be seen when comparing Figures 11 and 12. This somewhat decreased the issue however, If I continued with the project, I would include sprites from different camera angles as well.

Figure 11.
Virtual Playtesting



Note: A screenshot of a playtester playing In Memoriam recorded through Discord. From Virtual Playtesting [Screenshot], by Roan Clifford, 2025.

Figure 12.
Sand Level



Note: A screenshot of the second level of In Memoriam showing off the branching path collectable card [Screenshot], by Roan Clifford, 2025.



Conclusion

Developing In Memoriam put my programming and Unity skills to the test. Designing and programming the game's mechanics was a big undertaking and using playtesting to improve the project helped me take away a lot from this project.

(387 Words)



Closing Reflection 1

In technologist Mike Sharples' Messages in Bottles and Cultures (1999), he outlines six principles for writing as a designer. These principles, as outlined by Sharples, ensure that the writing of a professional allows the reader to properly understand the content of the work. In my portfolio, I kept Sharples' principles in mind, especially the principles of supporting, not misleading readers and providing justification for my assertions.

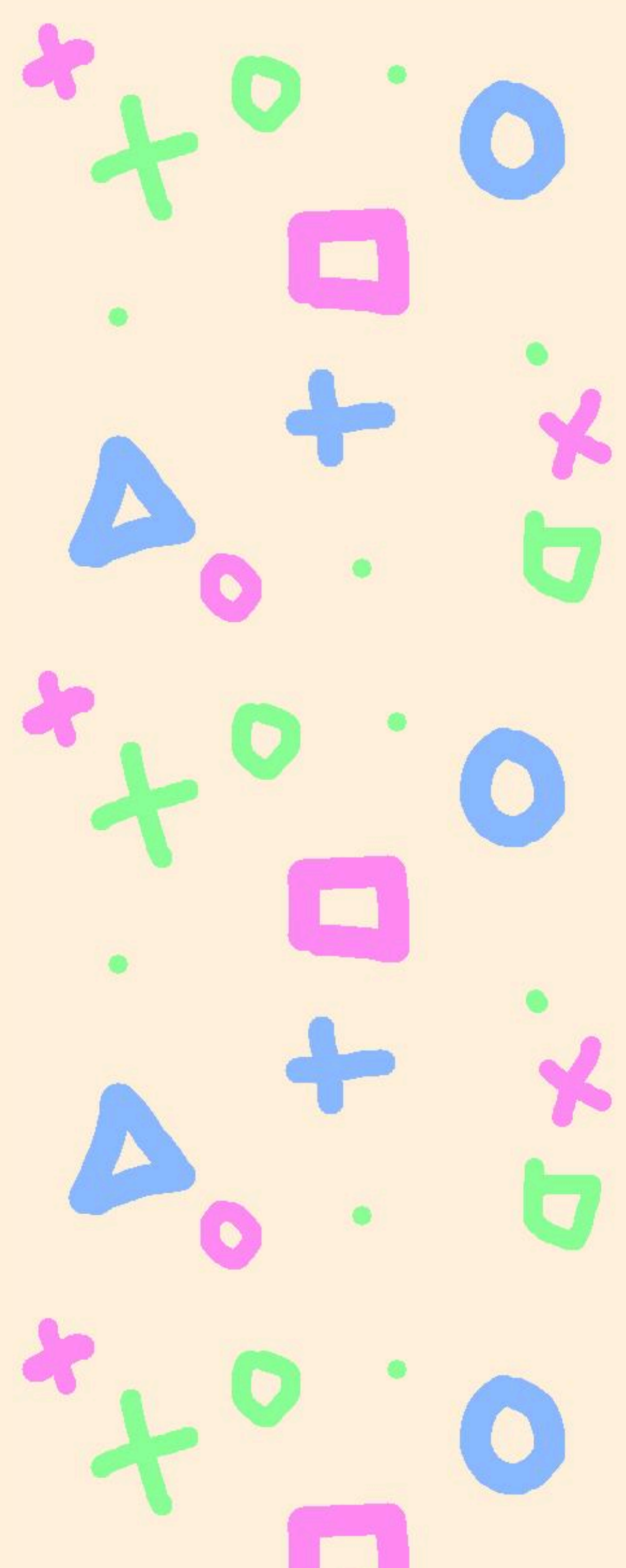
My portfolio aims to not mislead the reader, presenting my process in a way that assists them and their understanding of my work. For example, on page 8, rather than talking about state machines as a concept and how I implemented them, I avoid using technical jargon so the reader does not get confused or believe I am attempting to come off as more knowledgeable than I am, while still demonstrating my subject matter knowledge. I believe this improves my ethos as a professional by presenting myself and my capabilities accurately, not tricking the reader in any way, and building trust between them and myself.

Closing Reflection 2

I also aimed to ensure that I provide justification and proof for my claims as much as possible. In order to maintain my ethos as a creative professional, I wanted to ensure that if I claimed I did something in my work, I was able to provide evidence for it too. As seen on page 7 of my portfolio, by including figures that show my contributions to the art and narrative of In Memoriam, I prove visually that I did the work I claim to have done.

By following these principles, I define my ethos as trustworthy and adept. I believe that this showcases my subject matter and rhetorical knowledge to my audience which also proves my quality as a professional.

(292 Words)



References

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Clifford, R. (2025). Enemy Class [Screenshot].

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Clifford, R. (2025). Animating an Enemy in Unity [Screenshot].

Clifford, R. (2025). Virtual Playtesting [Screenshot].

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Sharples, M. (1999). Messages in Bottles. *How we Write: Writing as Creative Design* (pp. 153-167). Routledge